

music

It clearly wasn't easy being a woman in a world meant for men. Her husband, Sultan Backliwal, art expert and businessman, was supportive. She performed at concerts and earned kudos. However, all this came at a cost. "To play the sarod in a sitting posture, one has to press the instrument

against the stomach," she says. "Because of the rigorous practice and concerts, I had three miscarriages. But it didn't deter me from carrying on with music," Sharan Rani adds with a smile.

The Indian musical gharana has traditionally been a male preserve. Musicians preferred to teach only

the sons, while daughters were expected to conform to socially-mandated roles as homemakers. It was also difficult to host women students in the guru's house. Fingers were often raised at the proximity and intense relationship between a guru and his women shishya. As such, women were discouraged to



anupriya deotale

VIOLIN

Her's is a story of grit and confidence. As a little girl from Ujjain, Anupriya Deotale would go for vocal music classes regularly, but her mind was always in the next classroom where violin lessons were being taught. With time, her dream of learning to play the violin came true when she became a

student of sarod maestro Ustad Amjad Ali Khan. Initially tutored under Khan in Delhi, she later came under the wings of sarangi maestro Pandit Ram Narayan and sitar maestro Ustad Shahid Parvez. Deotale has also learnt from sarod maestro Mukesh Sharma.

Learning from different gurus with different styles has greatly enriched

Deotale's music. "I have tried to adopt the best of each gharana and develop my own style," she says.

Unlike many others, she had to work very hard to reach where she is today. "In such professions, being the son or daughter of a celeb guru-performer makes the path easier. But I have achieved everything because of my perseverance," she says.